NEUROCENTS · VIDEO 16 — CATALOG FORMAT

Every Money Bias & Its Effect Explained in 8 Minutes

ELEVENLABS — NARRATION ONLY · 81 lines · ~1210 words · ~9 min

Anchoring. Anchoring is your brain's habit of trusting the first number it sees.

It's everywhere. Price tags, salaries, menus. The most consumed bias on Earth.

You see a jacket: two hundred euros, crossed out. Now ninety.

The onset is instant. Ninety stops being a price — it becomes a bargain.

Your brain never asked if the jacket was worth ninety. It only compared it to two hundred.

At the peak, the crossed-out number does all your thinking. The real question — 'do I even want this?' — never loads.

The comedown arrives at home: a ninety-euro jacket you never planned to buy.

Repeated daily, anchoring quietly decides what 'normal' costs — rent, phones, haircuts, everything.

You never buy the thing. You buy the distance from the first number.

Loss Aversion. The oldest bias in the building.

Losing a hundred euros hurts about twice as much as winning a hundred feels good. That asymmetry runs your life.

The onset: you check a price, an account, an investment — and your chest tightens before your thoughts arrive.

At the peak, you'll do irrational things to avoid a small loss — hold a bad investment, keep a broken subscription, stay in the wrong plan.

Not to win. Just to not lose.

The comedown is invisible: all the better options you never took because they smelled like risk.

Long-term damage: a life optimized against losing is a life that never compounds.

Your brain doesn't protect your money. It protects the feeling of not losing it.

Mental Accounting. Your brain runs separate wallets for the same money.

Salary money is serious. Refund money is free. Birthday money is fun.

The onset: a hundred euros arrives outside your salary — and it lands in the 'doesn't count' wallet.

At the peak, you'll spend a tax refund in a weekend while agonizing over a forty-euro grocery bill.

Same currency. Same account. Different rules.

The comedown: at the end of the year, the 'free money' is gone and you can't name a single thing it built.

Money doesn't come with labels. Your brain prints them.

Present Bias. The dealer that always finds you.

To your brain, you-today is a real person. You-in-ten-years is a stranger in a stock photo.

The onset: 'I'll start saving next month.' It feels responsible. It's actually the high.

At the peak, today's wants outvote tomorrow's needs every single time — dinner beats retirement, now beats later.

The comedown never comes today. That's the design. The bill is always addressed to the stranger.

Until one morning you're the stranger, opening the mail.

Present bias doesn't steal your money. It borrows it from someone you haven't met yet — you.

Four down, six to go. If your brain has already shown up twice in this catalog — subscribe.

We name one of these programs every week. Free, painless, and mildly uncomfortable in the good way.

Herd Instinct. Social proof. The party drug.

Your brain outsources decisions to the crowd — if everyone's buying, it must be safe.

The onset feels like belonging: everyone has the phone, the trip, the coin, the sneakers.

At the peak, 'everyone's doing it' overrides every number you know. FOMO isn't fear of missing the thing — it's fear of standing outside the group.

The comedown hits when the crowd moves on and you're still holding the receipt.

The crowd got the memories. You got the credit card statement.

Herds are great protection against lions. There are no lions at the mall.

Lifestyle Inflation. The tolerance effect.

Every raise feels enormous for exactly one month.

The onset: more money arrives, and 'needs' quietly upgrade themselves to match. Better coffee. Better car. Better everything.

At the peak, you're earning double what you did five years ago — and saving exactly the same: nothing.

That's tolerance. The dose went up. The effect didn't.

The comedown is the trap itself: there is no comedown. It just becomes your baseline. Forever.

A raise doesn't make you richer. It makes your old life unaffordable.

Sunk Cost. The loyalty program of bad decisions.

You keep paying for the gym you don't attend, the course you don't finish, the project that died last year.

The onset is a sentence: 'But I've already put so much into it.'

At the peak, the past runs your future — you throw good money after bad, because quitting would make the loss real.

Here's what your brain hides from you: the money is already gone. It left when you spent it.

The comedown lasts years: every month you stay is another payment on a decision you already know was wrong.

You're not protecting your investment. You're buying tickets to watch it sink.

The Optimism Loop. Planning fallacy, if you want the lab name.

Next month, you'll spend less. Next month has been coming for nine years.

The onset: every budget you make stars a fictional character — a disciplined, unhurried you with no birthdays, no emergencies, no Fridays.

At the peak, you plan for the best month you've ever had — every month.

The comedown arrives on day twenty-something, with a calendar full of exceptions that were 'one-time things.' All twelve months have one-time things.

Optimism is a great life partner and a terrible accountant.

Default Bias. The silent subscription.

Whatever is already happening keeps happening — not because it's good, but because changing it requires a decision.

The onset is nothing. That's its trick. The same bank since you were eighteen. The same tariff. The same insurance, renewing itself in the dark.

At the peak, entire industries price your inertia into their business model — the loyalty penalty has a name because it's that reliable.

The comedown is spread so thin you never feel it: thirty euros here, sixty there, every month, for decades.

The most expensive decisions of your life are the ones you never made.

Scarcity Mindset. The heavy one.

When money has been tight long enough, scarcity stops being a situation and becomes an operating system.

The onset: money worries start taxing your attention — rent math running in the background of every conversation.

Researchers measured it: active financial scarcity can consume more cognitive capacity than a full night without sleep.

At the peak, the tunnel closes in. Today's fire is all there is. Long-term thinking isn't a choice you're refusing — it's a luxury the tunnel doesn't stock.

And the cruelest part: the tunnel makes the exact decisions that keep you in the tunnel.

The comedown isn't even yours. It's inherited — scarcity teaches children what money feels like before they ever earn any.

Poverty isn't just a number in an account. It's a full-time job your brain works for free.

Ten programs. One brain. Yours came pre-installed with all of them.

You can't uninstall a bias. Nobody can.

But a named program never runs quietly again — from now on, when one fires, some part of you will be watching.

That part is new. It didn't exist eight minutes ago.

Send this catalog to the friend who's deep in sunk cost right now. They'll know exactly which one they're on.

Next week: two people. Same salary. Same city. At forty-five, one of them stops needing to work.

The difference fits on a napkin. See you Thursday.

END OF SCRIPT · 81 lines · ~1210 words